

TrustLine — Solution Overview

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Confidential. Prepared by NexonAI Consulting SRL for legal review.

1. Purpose of this document

This overview explains the TrustLine concept so that you can judge which regulatory questions it raises in Jordan, Yemen and the wider MENA region. A separate document, the Legal Question Catalogue, lists all questions in full. TrustLine is at concept stage: no software is live, and no customer has been onboarded.

2. The problem

Money transfer operators reach beneficiaries through networks of agents. When two independent networks work together, they exchange payout instructions (“pay this amount to the person who presents code Y”) by phone, WhatsApp or e-mail. Nothing proves afterwards who authorised, received and paid an instruction.

- **Banks:** Correspondent banks, especially those clearing US dollars, close or restrict the accounts of operators whose processes they cannot verify (de-risking).
- **Supervisors:** Authorities expect complete records, oversight of agents, and originator and beneficiary information on every transfer (FATF Recommendations 11, 14 and 16).
- **Gap:** No neutral infrastructure exists for the instruction layer between independent networks.

3. What TrustLine is, and what it is not

TrustLine is the messaging and evidence layer for this gap. It is a closed network in which licensed network operators and their agents exchange payout instructions. Every instruction is digitally signed, passes mandatory checks and is written to a tamper-evident log. Operators can show these logs to their banks, supervisors, partner networks and auditors. The model is SWIFT's, at small scale: SWIFT carries messages between banks and does not move money, and TrustLine does the same for money transfer networks.

TrustLine is not:

- a payment system, wallet or issuer of e-money. It holds no funds, accounts or balances and does not settle.
- a KYC provider. Operators identify their customers and remain responsible for it.

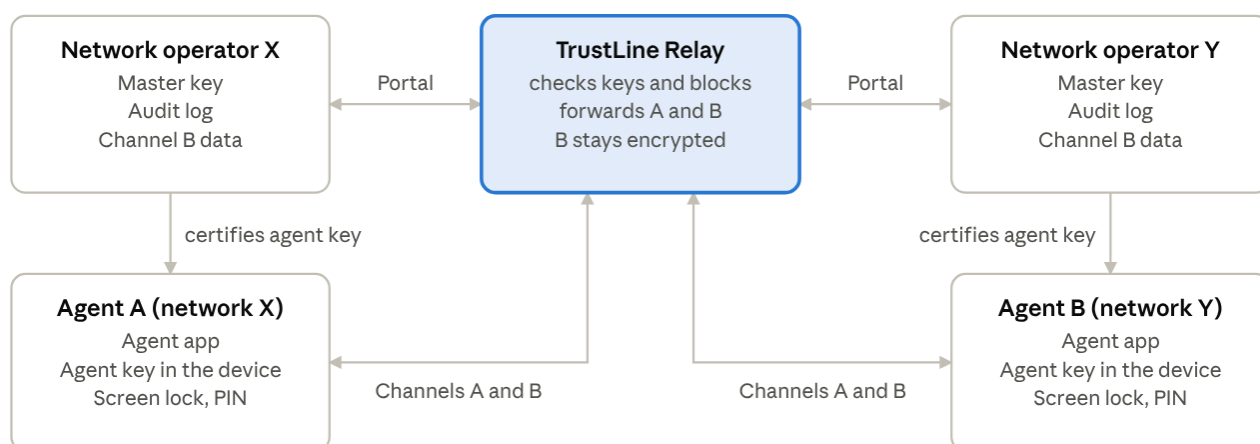
- able to read customer data (Section 6).

Settlement between operators continues through banks, cash or trade balances, outside TrustLine.

4. Parties

Party	Role
Network operator	Licensed money transfer operator (also called MSB or MTO) that runs an agent network under one brand. TrustLine's customer. Holds a master key and remains responsible to its supervisor for its agents.
Agent	Collection and payout point contracted by the operator, often an independent business. Uses the TrustLine app and has no contract with TrustLine.
TrustLine Relay	Central server operated by TrustLine. Forwards instructions between the agents of different operators, checks keys, issues receipts and keeps its own log.
Sender and beneficiary	The customers. They never interact with TrustLine. The sender passes a one-time payout code to the beneficiary.
Banks, supervisors, auditors	Receive evidence from the operator and may verify it with the Offline Auditor Tool (Section 8).

The relay forwards everything but cannot read the mandatory customer data



No funds pass through TrustLine. Settlement runs outside, between the network operators.

Channel A: instruction, no names. Channel B: customer data, end-to-end encrypted, unreadable to the relay.

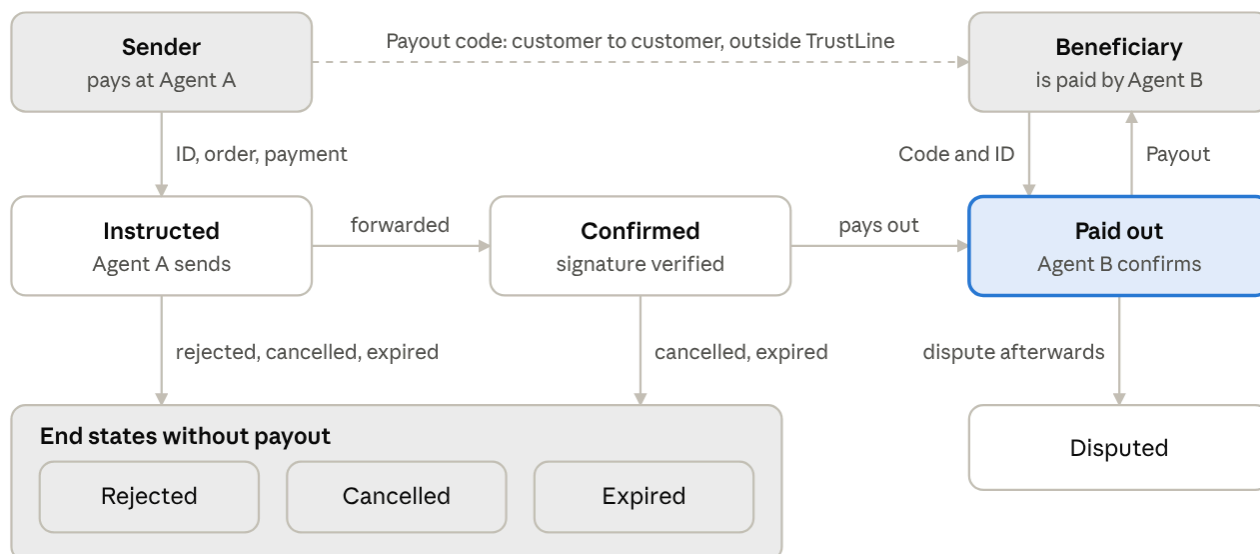
Parties and channels

5. How a transfer works

1. The sender presents ID and the order at Agent A and pays under the normal rules of operator X. Agent A enters the mandatory sender and beneficiary data in the app.
2. The app signs the instruction and sends it, together with the encrypted data package, to the Relay. The instruction counts as “Instructed” only after the Relay has issued a receipt.
3. After the receipt, the app shows a one-time payout code. The sender passes it to the beneficiary outside TrustLine.
4. The Relay runs the mandatory checks (Section 7) and forwards the instruction and the package to Agent B.
5. Agent B decrypts the package and verifies the signature. The status is “Confirmed”.
6. The beneficiary presents the code and ID at Agent B. The app checks the code, and the agent compares the name on the ID with the name in the package.
7. Agent B pays out and confirms in the app. The status is “Paid out”, and the code is used up.

Settlement between operators X and Y happens outside TrustLine.

An instruction ends in Paid out or without payout



Unique instruction number and payout code: Paid out can be set only once.

Life of an instruction, with customers

6. Data protection by design

Data travels on two channels. **Channel A** carries the instruction without names: unique number, time and expiry, amounts and currencies, corridor, purpose code, fingerprint of the payout code, fingerprint of the Channel B package, confirmation of sanctions screening by the sending operator, agent identifiers, status, and the digital signature.

Channel B carries the mandatory originator and beneficiary data: full names, address or ID number or date and place of birth, customer reference and payout location.

The app encrypts Channel B for three recipients only: the sending operator, the receiving operator and the receiving agent. The Relay cannot read it. It stores the encrypted package only until delivery, deletes it afterwards and keeps only the fingerprint. A fingerprint (hash) is a value calculated from data that changes if a single character of the data changes and reveals nothing about the data. The payout code is never sent in clear text, only as a fingerprint. Both operators store the data in their own systems and remain responsible for retention and for answering authorities.

7. Controls: due diligence, keys and mandatory checks

Due diligence. TrustLine admits only operators it has vetted. The file covers: corporate and licence documents for every country of operation; ownership down to natural persons and management; the AML/CFT and sanctions programmes and the compliance officer; the latest independent audit; the correspondent-bank questionnaire; the agent

network and agent contract; financial statements, banks and account closures; security and data protection policies; references; and signed declarations. TrustLine verifies licences with the register or supervisor, screens owners, management and agents against sanctions and PEP lists, researches adverse media, rates the risk and decides on a four-eyes basis. Files are renewed yearly, or half-yearly for high risk.

Keys and revocation. Each instruction is signed with an agent key certified by the operator's master key. The Relay rejects unknown or revoked keys, and the receiving app verifies every signature again. Keys can be revoked at three levels: one device (by the operator, immediately), one agent (by the operator or TrustLine) and a whole operator (by TrustLine, two people deciding, for example after loss of licence or a sanctions hit). Revocation applies from the next message the Relay receives. Completed payouts stay valid and provable; open instructions of the revoked party are frozen until reviewed. Every revocation is logged with reason and time, and the operator may appeal.

Mandatory checks on every instruction. The Relay checks that the keys are valid, that the two operators are connected for the corridor, that the corridor is not blocked, that all mandatory fields (including the sanctions screening confirmation) are present, that the instruction number is new and the expiry date lies ahead, and that the limits set by the operator are respected. Every result is logged. Nobody can switch these checks off.

8. Evidence and audit

Every instruction, confirmation, payout, cancellation and revocation is recorded in three independent logs: the sending operator's, the receiving operator's and the Relay's. In each log, every entry contains the fingerprint of the previous entry, so any later change, deletion or insertion breaks the chain visibly. The operators' logs are certified with their master keys, which TrustLine never holds. Records are kept for at least five years by default, adjustable per country.

The **Offline Auditor Tool** is a stand-alone program with which an auditor, bank compliance team or supervisor verifies an exported log without any connection to TrustLine: chain intact, signatures genuine, keys valid at the time, instructions present and consistent in all logs, no double payout, mandatory fields complete. It produces a report. The verification methods are published, so the auditor does not have to trust TrustLine.

9. Operation in the field

An agent needs an Android phone or tablet, or a Windows PC with a browser, with a screen lock and a hardware key store. A few kilobytes per instruction are enough, so a slow mobile connection works. The app is built for users who cannot read or write: icons,

voice prompts, scanning instead of typing. Agents are enrolled by their operator through a one-time QR code and sign no paperwork.

Without a connection the app can record instructions as “Pending” for up to 24 hours (adjustable); they count only after the Relay’s receipt. Payouts offline are possible only if the operator enables them, only for instructions already on the device and within an operator-defined limit. If the connection drops while sending, the app repeats the message, and the unique instruction number ensures that the Relay never creates two instructions. An instruction that is never delivered expires, and the operator refunds the customer under its own rules.

10. Pilot, customers and business model

The pilot is planned for corridors in MENA and sub-Saharan Africa, mostly in US dollars. The customers are network operators. Later groups under consideration are humanitarian organisations that distribute cash through operators and need evidence for donors, and supervisors and central banks that could receive read-only evidence with a legal basis and the operator’s consent. TrustLine charges a fee per active agent per month and per due diligence review. It charges no fee based on transaction value.

11. Legal positioning: assumptions we want to test

- TrustLine is a technology and evidence service provider, not a payment service or payment system operator.
- The operators remain the regulated entities for all customer-facing duties: identification, sanctions screening, suspicious-activity reporting and record-keeping.
- Temporary storage of encrypted packages that TrustLine cannot read is transport, not processing of readable personal data.
- Because US-dollar settlement runs through banks, US sanctions standards apply in practice. TrustLine applies them voluntarily to all participants.
- Digital signatures and tamper-evident logs are acceptable evidence for supervisors, banks and courts.

We would like to test each of these assumptions for Jordan and Yemen.

12. What we would like from you

Please let us know whether you can advise us on the questions in the Legal Question Catalogue, and give us your view on scope, timing and fees and on whether separate Yemeni counsel is needed. We ask that no authority or third party be approached about TrustLine without our prior agreement.